



Policy Safeguarding Children

1. Linslade Galaxy Football Club, (LGFC), a Charter Standard Football Club acknowledges its responsibility to safeguard the welfare of every child and young person who has been entrusted to its care and is committed to working to provide a safe environment for all members. A child or young person is anyone under the age of 18 engaged in any club football activity. We subscribe to The Football Association's (The FA) Safeguarding Children – Policy and Procedures and endorse and adopt the Policy Statement contained in that document. The document is available to download from LGFC's website.

- 2.** The key principles of The FA Safeguarding Children Policy are that:
- the child's welfare is, and must always be, the paramount consideration
 - all children and young people have a right to be protected from abuse regardless of their age, gender, disability, race, sexual orientation, faith or belief
 - all suspicions and allegations of abuse will be taken seriously and responded to swiftly and appropriately
 - working in partnership with other organisations, children and young people and their parents/carers is essential.

We acknowledge that every child or young person who plays or participates in football should be able to take part in an enjoyable and safe environment and be protected from poor practice and abuse.

Linslade Galaxy Charter Standard Football Club recognises that this is the responsibility of every adult involved in our club.

3. Linslade Galaxy Charter Standard Football Club has a role to play in safeguarding the welfare of all children and young people by protecting them from physical, sexual or emotional harm and from neglect or bullying. It is noted and accepted that The Football Association's Safeguarding Children Regulations (see The FA Handbook) applies to everyone in football whether in a paid or voluntary capacity. This means whether you are a volunteer, match official, helper on club tours, football coach, club official or medical staff.

4. We endorse and adopt The FA's Responsible Recruitment guidelines for recruiting volunteers and we will:

- Specify what the role is and what tasks it involves (role descriptions are available for all volunteer roles in LGFC)
- Request identification documents
- As a minimum meet and chat with the applicant(s) and where possible interview people before appointing them
- Ask for and follow up with 2 references before appointing someone
- Require an FA DBS Enhanced Disclosure where appropriate in line with FA guidelines.

All current **Linslade Galaxy Charter Standard** Football Club members who are regularly caring for, supervising, training or being in sole charge of children and young people will be required to complete a DBS Enhanced Disclosure via The FA DBS Unit.

If there are concerns regarding the appropriateness of an individual who is already involved or who has approached us to become part of **Linslade Galaxy Charter Standard** Football Club guidance will be sought from The Football Association. It is noted and accepted that The FA will consider the relevance and significance of the information obtained via The FA DBS Unit Enhanced Disclosure and that all decisions will be made in the best interests of children and young people.

It is accepted that The FA aims to prevent people with a history of relevant and significant offending from having contact with children or young people and the opportunity to influence policies or practice with children or young people. This is to prevent direct sexual or physical harm to children and to minimise the risk of 'grooming' within football.

5. Linslade Galaxy Charter Standard Football Club supports The FA's Whistle Blowing Policy and has incorporated the FA's Whistle Blowing Policy into the Club's own policy. Any adult or young person with concerns about a colleague can 'whistle blow' by contacting The FA Safeguarding Team on 0207 745 4787, by writing to The FA Case Manager at The Football Association, 25 Soho Square, W1D 4FA or alternatively by going direct to the Police, Children's Services or the NSPCC.

Linslade Galaxy Charter Standard Football Club encourages everyone to know about it and utilise it if necessary.

6. Linslade Galaxy Charter Standard Football Club has appointed a Club Welfare Officer in line with The FA's role profile and required completion of the Safeguarding Children and Welfare Officers Workshop. The post holder will be involved with Welfare Officer Training provided by The FA and/or County FA. The Club Welfare Officer (and/or Team Welfare Officer) is the first point of contact for all club members regarding concerns about the welfare of any child or young person. The Club Welfare Officer will liaise directly with the County FA (CFA) Welfare Officer and will be familiar with the procedures for referring any concerns. They will also play a proactive role in increasing awareness of **Respect**, poor practice and abuse amongst club members.

7. We acknowledge and endorse The FA's identification of bullying as a category of abuse. Bullying of any kind is not acceptable at our club. If bullying does occur, all players or parents/carers should be able to tell and know that incidents will be dealt with promptly. Incidents need to be reported to the Team Welfare Officer/Club Welfare Officer and in cases of serious bullying the CFA Welfare Officer may be contacted.

8. Respect codes of conduct for Players, Parents/ Spectators, Officials and Coaches have been implemented by **Linslade Galaxy Charter Standard** Football Club. In order to validate these **Respect** codes of conduct the club has clear actions it will take regarding repeated or serious misconduct at club level and acknowledges the possibility of potential sanctions which may be implemented by the County FA in more serious circumstances. All members of LGFC will be required to sign and adopt the Respect codes of conduct.

9. Reporting your concerns about the welfare of a child or young person.

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility if you are worried about a child it is important that you report your concerns – no action is not an option.

- (i)** If you are worried about a child then you need to report your concerns to the Team Welfare Officer and/or the Club Welfare Officer.

(ii) If the issue is one of poor practice the Team and/or Club Welfare Officer will either:

- deal with the matter themselves or
- seek advice from the CFA Welfare Officer

(iii) If the concern is more serious – possible child abuse, where possible, contact the CFA Welfare Officer first, then immediately contact the Police or Children’s Services

(iv) If the child needs immediate medical treatment take them to a hospital or call an ambulance and tell them this is a child protection concern. Let your Team and/or Club Welfare Officer know what action you have taken, they in turn will inform the CFA Welfare Officer.

(v) If at any time you are not able to contact your Team Welfare Officer/Club Welfare Officer or the matter is clearly serious then you can either:

- contact your CFA Welfare Officer directly
- contact the Police or Children’s Services
- call The FA/NSPCC 24 hour Helpline for advice on 0808 800 5000 or Deaf users text phone 0800 056 0566

NB – The FA’s Safeguarding Children Policy and Procedures are available via www.TheFA.com/Footballsafe – click on the ‘downloads’ under Policy and Procedures. They are also available to download from LGFC’s website on the Safeguarding and Policies pages. The policy outlines in detail what to do if you are concerned about the welfare of a child and includes flow diagrams which describe this process. How to make a referral is also covered in the Safeguarding Children workshop. Participants are given the opportunity to discuss how this feels and how best they can prepare themselves to deal with such a situation.

For more information on this workshop contact your County Welfare Officer.

10. Further advice on Safeguarding Children matters can be obtained from:

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- **Anne Stunell**

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- **Sarah DaCosta**

County Football Association’s Welfare Officer

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- www.TheFA.com/Footballsafe
- Emailing – Footballsafe@TheFA.com
- The FA Safeguarding Children general enquiry line 0845 210 8080